

Phishing Protection for Microsoft O365

Deployment and Configuration Guide

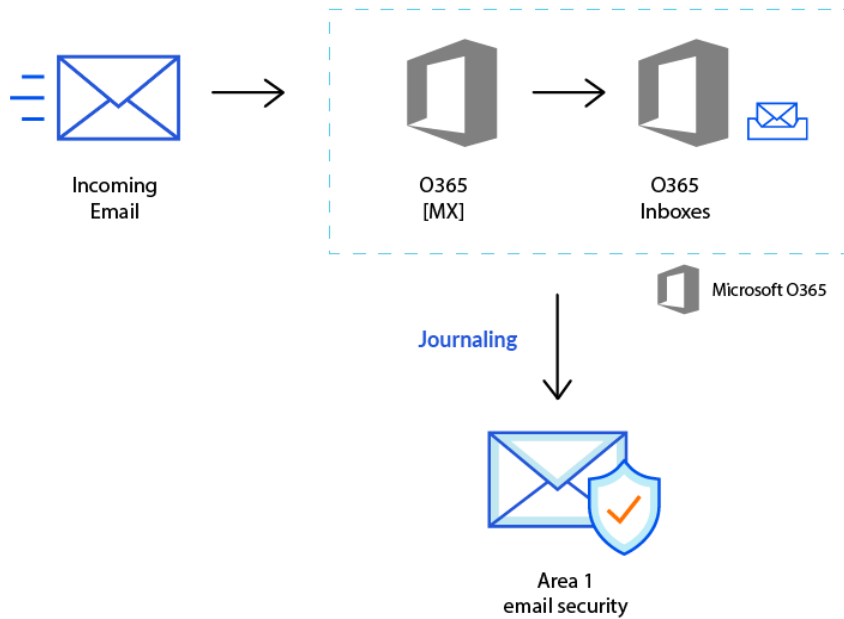
O365 Journaling

Cloudflare Area 1 Overview

Phishing is the root cause of upwards of 90% of security breaches that lead to financial loss and brand damage. Cloudflare Area 1 is a cloud-native service that stops phishing attacks, the #1 cybersecurity threat, across all traffic vectors - email, web and network.

With globally distributed sensors and comprehensive attack analytics, Area 1 cloud email security proactively identifies phishing campaigns, attacker infrastructure, and attack delivery mechanisms during the earliest stages of a phishing attack cycle. Using flexible enforcement platforms, Area 1 allows customers to take preemptive action against these targeted phishing attacks across all vectors - email, web and network; either at the edge or in the cloud.

Email Flow



Configuration Steps

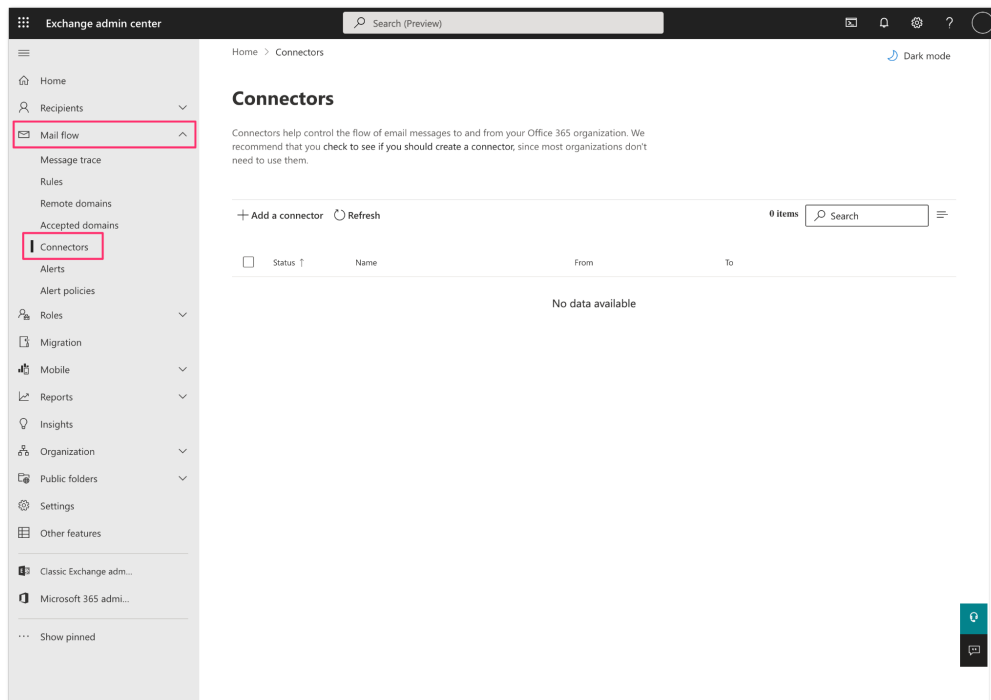
- Step 1: Configure connector for delivery to Area 1 (if required)
- Step 2: Configure Journal Rule

Step 1: Configure connector for delivery to Cloudflare Area 1 (if required)

If your email architecture does not include an outbound gateway, you can skip and proceed to the next step of this configuration guide..

If your email architecture requires outbound messages to traverse your email gateway, you may want to consider configuring a connector to send the journal messages directly to Area 1.

1. Open the Exchange admin center, and access the **Connectors** configuration under the **Mail flow** menu at <https://admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/connectors>



2. Click the **+ Add a connector** button to configure a new connector and configure the connector mail direction as follows:

- **Connection From:** Office 365
- **Connection to:** Partner Organization

The screenshot shows the 'Exchange admin center' interface with the 'Add a connector' wizard open. The wizard is titled 'Add a connector' and has a close button (X) in the top right corner. On the left side of the wizard, there is a vertical progress bar with steps: 'New connector' (selected), 'Name', 'Use of connector', 'Routing', 'Security restrictions', 'Validation email', and 'Review connector'. The main content area is titled 'New connector' and contains the following text: 'Specify your mail flow scenario, and we'll let you know if you need to set up a connector.' Below this text, there are two sections: 'Connection from' and 'Connection to'. The 'Connection from' section has three radio button options: 'Office 365' (selected), 'Your organization's email server', and 'Partner organization'. The 'Connection to' section has two radio button options: 'Your organization's email server' and 'Partner organization' (selected). At the bottom right of the wizard, there is a 'Next' button.

3. Configure the connector name and description:

- **Name:** Deliver journal directly to Area 1
- **Description:** Deliver journal directly to Area 1
- Select the **Turn it on** checkbox

The screenshot shows the Exchange admin center interface with the 'Add a connector' wizard open. The left sidebar contains the navigation menu with 'Connectors' selected. The wizard has a progress bar with steps: New connector (checked), Name (active), Use of connector, Routing, Security restrictions, Validation email, and Review connector. The 'Name' step is active, showing the 'Connector name' section. Below the title, a note states: 'This connector enforces routing and security restrictions for email messages sent from Office 365 to your partner organization or service provider.' There are two text input fields: 'Name' with the value 'Deliver journal directly to Area 1' and 'Description' with the value 'Deliver journal directly to Area 1'. At the bottom, under 'What do you want to do after connector is saved?', the 'Turn it on' checkbox is checked. 'Back' and 'Next' buttons are at the bottom right.

Exchange admin center

Home > Connectors

Connectors

Connectors help recommend the need to use the

+ Add a connector

☐ Status

Home

Recipients

Mail flow

Message trace

Rules

Remote domains

Accepted domains

Connectors

Alerts

Alert policies

Roles

Migration

Mobile

Reports

Insights

Organization

Public folders

Settings

Other features

Classic Exchange admin...

Microsoft 365 admin...

Show pinned

Add a connector

New connector ☒

Name ☒

Use of connector ☐

Routing ☐

Security restrictions ☐

Validation email ☐

Review connector ☐

Connector name

This connector enforces routing and security restrictions for email messages sent from Office 365 to your partner organization or service provider.

Name *

Deliver journal directly to Area 1

Description

Deliver journal directly to Area 1

What do you want to do after connector is saved?

☒ Turn it on

Back Next

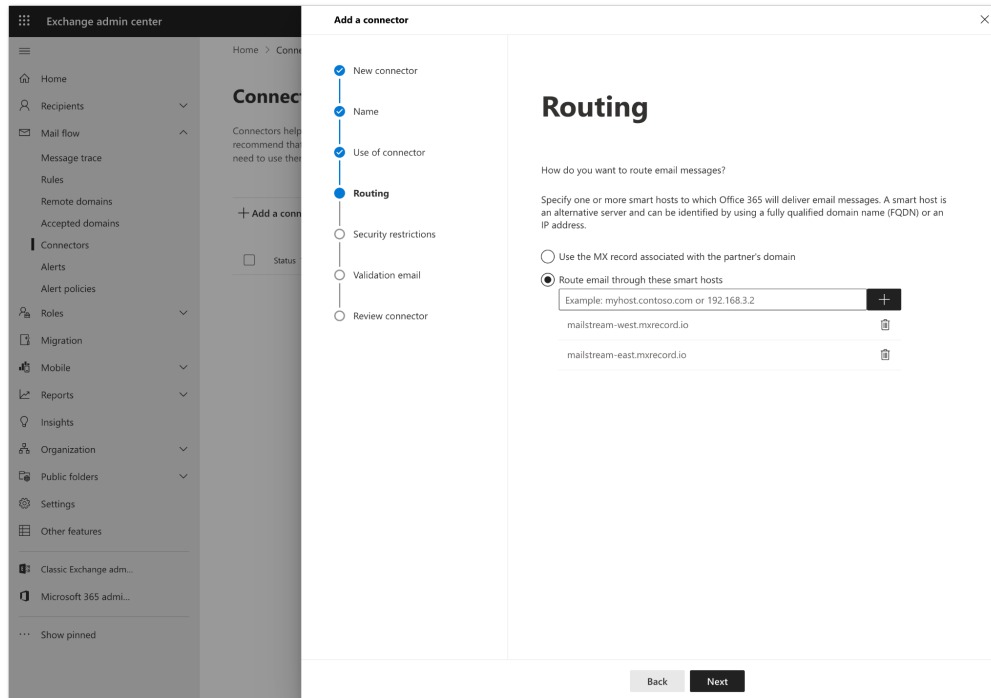
4. Configure the **Use of connector** setting:

- Select **Only when email messages are sent to these domains** option
- Enter **journaling.mxrecord.io** in the text field and click **+** to add domain.

The screenshot shows the 'Exchange admin center' interface with the 'Add a connector' wizard open. The wizard has a progress bar with steps: New connector, Name, Use of connector (current), Routing, Security restrictions, Validation email, and Review connector. The 'Use of connector' step is active, showing the title 'Use of connector' and the instruction 'Specify when you want to use this connector.' There are two radio button options: 'Only when I have a transport rule set up that redirects messages to this connector' and 'Only when email messages are sent to these domains'. The second option is selected. Below the options is a text input field with the placeholder 'Example: * or *.contoso.com or *.com' and a '+' button to add domains. The domain 'journaling.mxrecord.io' has been entered in the field. At the bottom of the wizard, there are 'Back' and 'Next' buttons.

5. Configure the **Routing** setting by selecting the **Route email through these smart hosts** and specifying the following smarthosts. Click the **+** button after each hosts to add them to the configuration:

- mailstream-east.mxrecord.io
- mailstream-west.mxrecord.io



If there is a requirement to enforce traffic through the EU region use the following smarthost instead:

- mailstream-eu1.mxrecord.io

6. Preserve the default TLS configuration:

The screenshot shows the Exchange Admin Center interface with the 'Add a connector' wizard open. The wizard is at the 'Security restrictions' step, which is highlighted in the progress bar. The left sidebar shows the 'Connectors' section expanded. The main content area asks 'How should Office 365 connect to your partner organization's email server?' and provides three options: 'Always use Transport Layer Security (TLS) to secure the connection (recommended)' (checked), 'Connect only if the recipient's email server certificate matches this criteria', and 'Any digital certificate, including self-signed certificates'. Below these options, there is a checkbox for 'Issued by a trusted certificate authority (CA)' and a checkbox for 'Add the subject name or subject alternative name (SAN) matches this domain name:'. An example domain 'contoso.com or *.contoso.com' is shown in a text box. At the bottom of the wizard, there are 'Back' and 'Next' buttons.

Exchange admin center

Home > Connectors

Connectors

Connectors help recommend the need to use the

+ Add a connector

☐ Status

Home

Recipients

Mail flow

Message trace

Rules

Remote domains

Accepted domains

Connectors

Alerts

Alert policies

Roles

Migration

Mobile

Reports

Insights

Organization

Public folders

Settings

Other features

Classic Exchange admin center

Microsoft 365 admin center

... Show pinned

Add a connector

New connector

Name

Use of connector

Routing

Security restrictions

Validation email

Review connector

Security restrictions

How should Office 365 connect to your partner organization's email server?

☒ Always use Transport Layer Security (TLS) to secure the connection (recommended)
Connect only if the recipient's email server certificate matches this criteria

☐ Any digital certificate, including self-signed certificates

☒ Issued by a trusted certificate authority (CA)

☐ Add the subject name or subject alternative name (SAN) matches this domain name:
Example: contoso.com or *.contoso.com

Back Next

7. Validate the connector by using your tenant's specific journaling address. This address can be found in the Area 1 Horizon portal in the Support > Service Addresses page (<https://horizon.area1security.com/support/service-addresses>):

The screenshot shows the 'Exchange admin center' interface with the 'Add a connector' wizard open. The wizard has a progress bar on the left with steps: New connector, Name, Use of connector, Routing, Security restrictions, Validation email (current step), and Review connector. The 'Validation email' step is active, showing a text input field with the placeholder 'Example: user@contoso.com' and a '+' button. Below the input field, the email address 'address@journaling.mxrecord.io' is displayed. A 'Validate' button is located below the email address. At the bottom of the wizard, there are 'Back' and 'Next' buttons.

9. Once the validation completes, you should receive a **Succeeded** status for all the tasks:

The screenshot shows the Exchange admin center interface with the 'Add a connector' wizard open. The wizard is at the 'Validation email' step, which is highlighted with a blue dot. The left sidebar shows the 'Connectors' section expanded. The main content area displays the 'Validation email' step, which includes a text input field for an email address, a 'Validate' button, and a table of tasks.

Validation email

Specify an email address for an active mailbox that's on your partner domain. You can add multiple addresses if your partner organization has more than one domain.

Example: user@contoso.com

address@journaling.msrecord.io

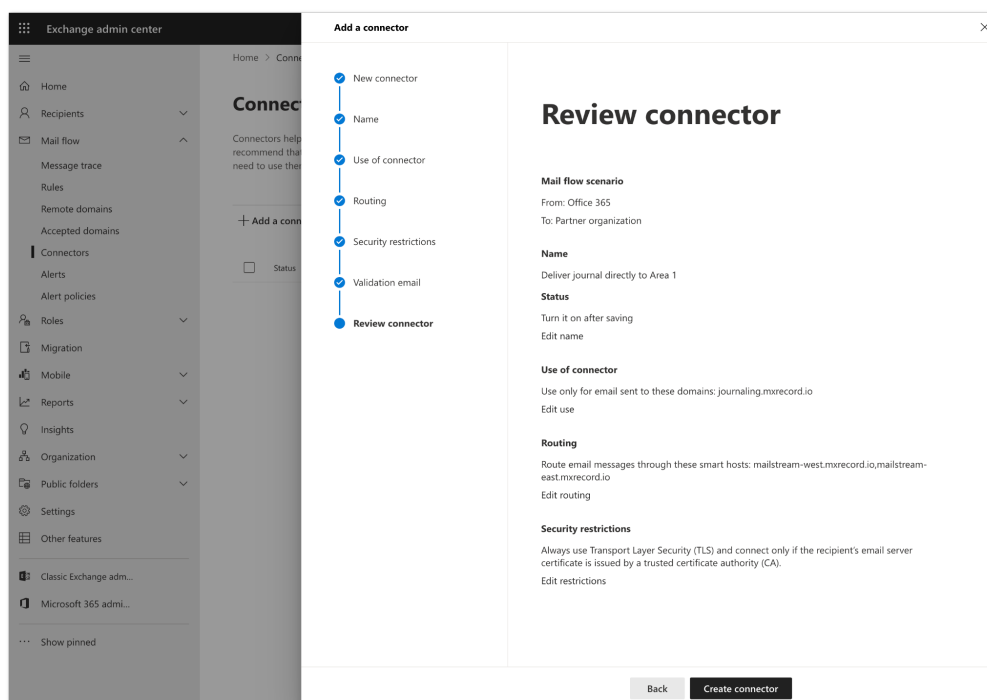
Validate

Validation successful

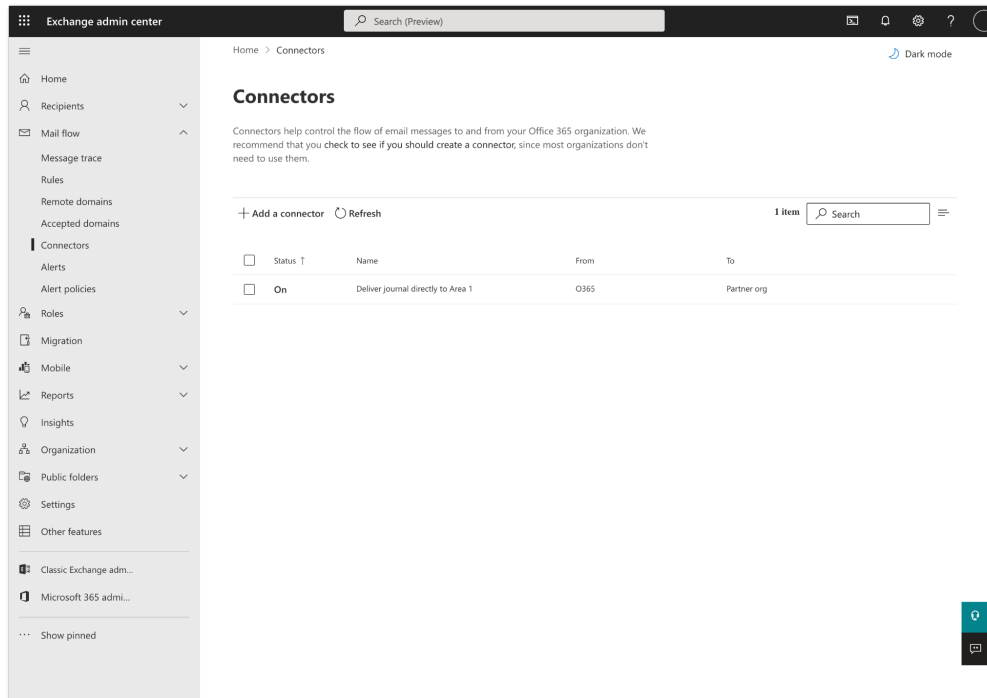
Task	Status
Check connectivity to 'mailstream-west.msrecord.io'	Succeed
Check connectivity to 'mailstream-east.msrecord.io'	Succeed
Send test email	Succeed

Back Next

- Review the configuration and click the **Create connector** button to save the configuration:



10. Once saved, the connector will be active:



Step 2: Configure Journal Rule

1. Open the Microsoft Purview compliance portal at <https://compliance.microsoft.com/homepage>
2. From the Purview compliance portal under the left menu, select **Data lifecycle management**, then select **Exchange (legacy)**
3. From the **Exchange (legacy)** page, select the **Settings** in the top right.
4. Enter the email address for a valid User account and select **Save**. Note: you cannot use a Team or Group address.

Exchange (legacy) > Settings

Settings

Undeliverable reports

Undeliverable reports

Specify an email address to receive journal reports when they are not deliverable to the address specified in the journal rule. This email address can't correspond with an Exchange Online mailbox. [Learn more about undeliverable reports](#)

Send undeliverable journal reports to: *

Save

5. Select **Exchange (legacy)** in the menu or breadcrumbs near the top, then select the **Journal Rules** configuration section.

Exchange (legacy) Settings

MRM Retention policies MRM Retention tags Journal rules

ⓘ We do not recommend journaling content outside of Microsoft 365. We recommend using Microsoft Purview suite of solutions to help meet legal, regulatory and organizational compliance requirements. [Learn about Microsoft Purview](#)

Use journal rules to record all communications in support of your organization's email retention or archival strategy. [Learn about journaling in Exchange Online](#)

[+ New rule](#) [Refresh](#) 3 items

Name	Status	User	Send journal reports to
------	--------	------	-------------------------

6. Select **New rule** to configure a journaling rule, and configure the journaling rule as follows then select **Next**:

- Send journal reports to: This address is specific to each customer tenant and can be found in your Portal at

<https://horizon.area1security.com/support/service-addresses>

- If you are located in the EU or GDPR applies to your organization please ensure you are using a Connector with the smarthost set to mailstream-eu1.mxrecord.io as per the start of this guide.
- Journal Rule Name: Journal Messages to CloudflareArea 1
- Journal messages sent or received from: Everyone
- Type of message to journal: External messages only

Exchange (legacy) > Create journal rule

Journal rule settings

Finish

Define journal rule settings

Messages matching the rule's conditions will be delivered to the journaling address specified in the rule. [Learn more to manage journaling in Exchange Online](#)

Send journal reports to *

journal_address@journaling.mxrecord.io

Journal rule name *

Journal Messages to CloudflareArea 1

Journal messages sent or received from *

☒ Everyone

☐ A specific user or group

Type of message to journal *

☐ All messages

☐ Internal messages only

☒ External messages only

Next Cancel

7. Verify the information is correct then select **Submit**.

Exchange (legacy) > Create journal rule

Journal rule settings

Finish

Review journal rule and finish

Send journal reports to

journal_address@journaling.mxrecord.io

[Edit](#)

Name

Journal Messages to CloudflareArea 1

[Edit](#)

Journal messages sent or received from

[Edit](#)

Type of message to journal

External messages only

[Edit](#)

Back Submit Cancel

8. Click **Done**. Once saved the rule is automatically active and may take a few minutes for the configuration to propagate and start to push messages to Cloudflare Area 1.

You can now access the Cloudflare Area 1 portal and you should see the number of messages processed counter increment as Journaled messages are sent to Cloudflare Area 1.

Restricting the Journal rule to specific users/groups:

Another option is to apply the Journal rule created in above step to some messages, the following can be enforced:

- **Journal messages sent or received from:** [A specific user or group]

Microsoft Purview

Exchange (legacy) > Create journal rule

Journal rule settings

Finish

Define journal rule settings

Messages matching the rule's conditions will be journaled. [Manage journaling in Exchange Online](#)

Send journal reports to *

journal_recipient@journaling.mxrecord.io

Journal rule name *

Journal Messages to CloudflareArea 1

Journal messages sent or received from *

☐ Everyone

☒ A specific user or group

Select a user or group

Type of message to journal *

☐ All messages

☐ Internal messages only

☒ External messages only

Next

Select a user or group to journal

Search for specific people

1 selected

Name	Email address
wattnias.koenier	wattnias.k@someodemocorp.com
Nick Perry	Nick@someodemocorp.com
PilotUsers	PilotUsers@someodemocorp.com
RBACDistribution	Alton2@someodemocorp.com
RBACMailEnableSecurity	Alton3@someodemocorp.com
Recoverable items	RecoverableItems@someodemocorp.onmicroso...
Scott Harris	scott.harris@someodemocorp.com
Seiya Tanaka	Seiya@someodemocorp.com
someodemocorp Bcc Address	someodemocorp.com@mxrecord.io
☒ Test	Test@someodemocorp.com
test	test_arun@someodemocorp.com
Todd Murray	todd@someodemocorp.onmicrosoft.com

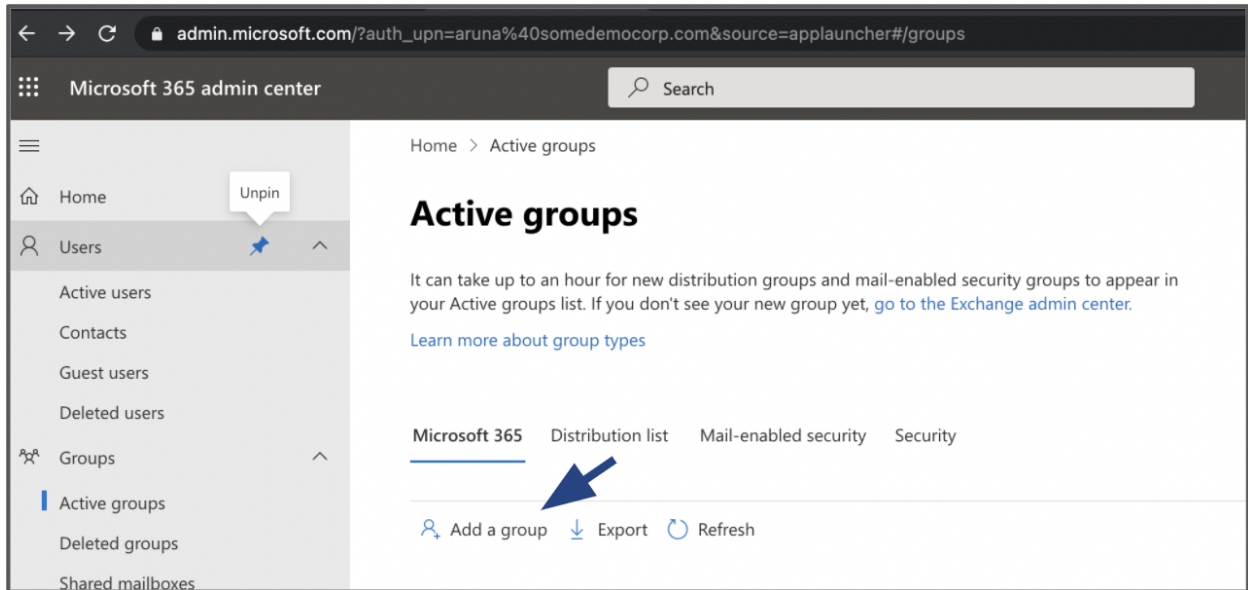
Add Cancel

- From the window that pops up with the list of users/groups, select the corresponding distribution group.

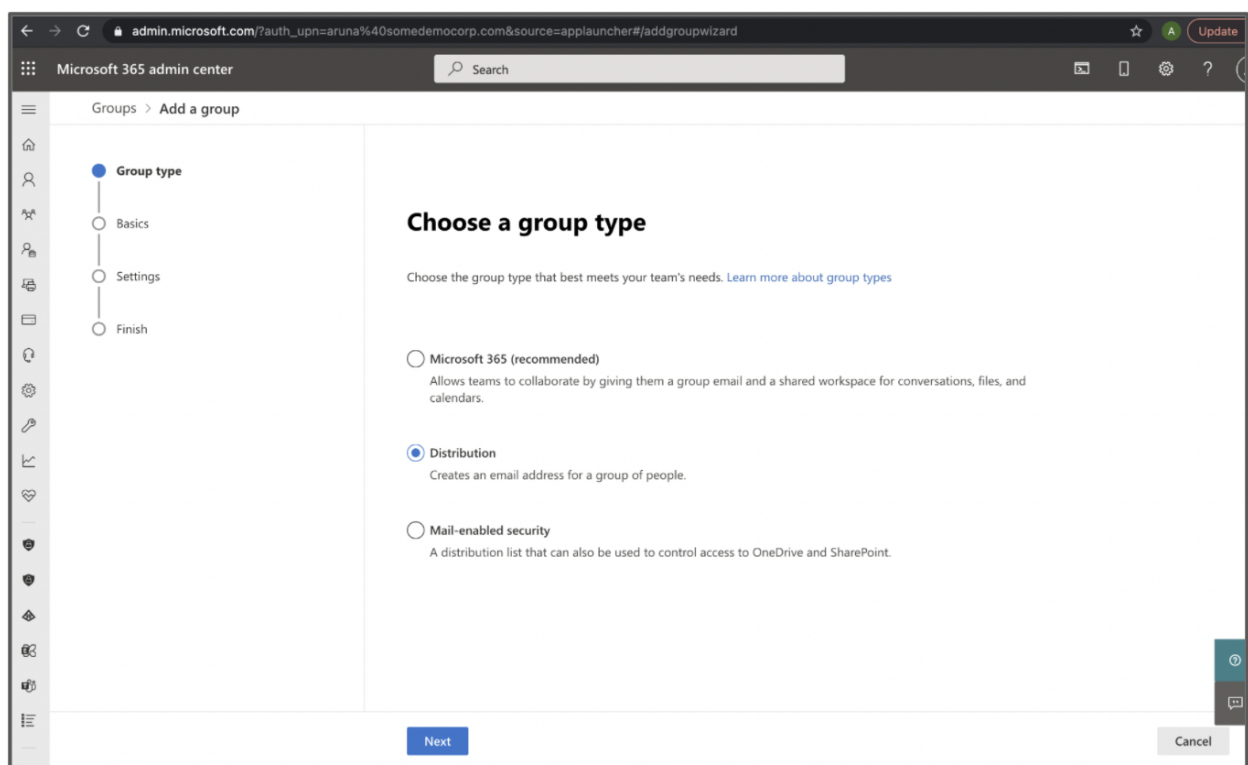
Creating distribution group in O365

If you do not have a distribution group yet, you can follow the below steps to create one.

Navigate to: Microsoft Exchange Admin Center > Home > Active Groups



Click 'Add a group' > Select 'Distribution' > Click Next



Enter a group name > Click Next > And hit 'Create Group'

The screenshot shows the 'Add a group' wizard in the Microsoft 365 admin center. The left sidebar indicates the progress: 'Group type' (checked), 'Basics' (checked), 'Settings' (active), and 'Finish' (disabled). The main content area is titled 'Edit settings' and shows the 'Distribution group' settings. The 'Group email address' field is set to 'Test' with a dropdown menu showing 'somedemocorp.com'. Below this, there is a checkbox for 'Communication' with the label 'Allow people outside of my organization to send email to this Distribution group', which is currently unchecked. At the bottom, there are 'Back', 'Next', and 'Cancel' buttons.

Navigate to the corresponding distribution group created and add the users:

The screenshot shows the 'Active groups' page in the Microsoft 365 admin center. The left sidebar shows the navigation menu with 'Groups' > 'Active groups' selected. The main content area shows a list of distribution groups. A blue arrow points to the 'Test' group in the list.

Group name ↑	Group email	Sync status	Created on	Choose columns
List	list@o365.somedemocorp.com	☑	March 23, 2017, 5:58 AM	
RBACDistribution	Alton2@somedemocorp.com	☑	October 18, 2020, 7:18 P	
test	test_arun@somedemocorp.com	☑	August 26, 2021, 2:35 PM	
Test	Test@somedemocorp.com	☑	August 27, 2021, 12:42 F	